The American intelligence report, however, cautioned that his efforts would bear fruit only if he ordered an impartial investigation of the anti-Sikh riots and placated moderate Sikh leaders for peaceful talks.

Gandhi was not averse to the idea of placating the youth and moderates and on 5 November 1986, the Prime Minister's Office (PMO) asked the Ministry of Human Resource Development (HRD) to examine the suggestions forwarded by Jogi. Other government arms launched programmes to mobilise youth activities in Punjab and coordinate development measures at grassroots levels. But as far as Prime Minister Gandhi was concerned, these attempts to engage the youth of Punjab were half-hearted. A note from Sarla Grewal, secretary to Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi, to R. Gopalaswamy, secretary of the Department of Youth Affairs and Sports, on 4 March 1987, was self-explanatory:

The position as reported in your letter was submitted to the Prime Minister (Rajiv Gandhi). Prime Minister was not happy with the progress achieved and felt that a more concerted effort ought to be mounted. It was in this

context that I had scheduled a meeting on 3rd March, 1987 to discuss various aspects thoroughly. It is indeed unfortunate you could not find it convenient to attend this meeting. The consensus reached at the meeting was that an inter-ministerial and multi-disciplinary approach had to be adopted to achieve significant results. Bringing the misguided youth back into the national mainstream is a delicate task and without appropriate inputs from various sources, programmes devised for this purpose may either lose focus or have little consequence.